



Board Of Works, March 4, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D4K0wqDR2n8
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1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Muncie Board of Public Works and Safety was called to order on March 4th by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Ted Baker, Mau (full name not specified in roll call), and Alan Wisley (referenced during opening remarks/roll call).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Ted Baker (identified through leading proceedings and calls to vote).
 - **Members Absent:** None explicitly noted.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance. Citizen recognition was given to Lacy for her work keeping minutes and organizing board agendas.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the February 25th meeting were presented and approved by voice vote.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:01:11](#) Register of Claims

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig Wright, City Controller.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Controller Wright presented the register of claims, noting items including IT contracts, an EMS claim to Stryker Sales for monitors, and regular weekly health insurance, utility, and health care costs. Total claims presented equaled \$1,063,950.00.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:02:20).
- **00:02:29 Street Closure Application: Game Changers RC Annual Mayday Event 2026**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Leanne Barton and Amber (Event Coordinator), Game Changers Riding Club.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The applicants requested road closures for their 5th annual Mayday car and bike show event. Requested closures include Wiser Street from Walnut to Jefferson, and Mulberry Street from Wiser to North. The board noted a letter of approval from Chief Sloan and confirmed security measures.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:03:59).
- **00:04:06 Street Closure Applications: Downtown Development Partnership (Three Events)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Cheryl Crowder, Downtown Development Partnership, accompanied by new Executive Director Amanda Homequist.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Crowder presented three recurring downtown street closure requests:
 1. *Brink of Summer Arts Walk* (June 4th, 2:00 PM <U+2013> 8:30 PM): Walnut Street from Charles to the roundabout.
 2. *Fire Up Downtown* (August 1st): Walnut from Main to the roundabout, Charles, Adams, and Jackson Streets from Mulberry to High, plus the 100 block of Walnut Street starting at 10:00 PM on Friday evening for stage setup. Expected attendance is targeted at 20,000.
 3. *Fall Arts Walk* (October 1st, 3:00 PM <U+2013> 8:00 PM): Walnut Street from Charles to the roundabout.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Brink of Summer Arts Walk: Approved by Voice Vote (00:06:24).
 - Fire Up Downtown: Approved by Voice Vote (00:06:42).
 - October 1 Arts Walk: Approved by Voice Vote (00:06:54).
- **00:08:02 Public Works Professional Services Contract: City of Muncie and WSP USA Inc.**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mayor Dan Ridenour.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mayor Ridenour presented a continuation of the city's general engineering and professional services contract with WSP USA Inc. for the year on an hourly basis, with a not-to-exceed amount of \$592,680.00, paid from various sources.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Rick Yenser asked for clarification, noting he thought it was an engineering contract rather than a general services contract. Staff

- confirmed it covers overall general professional/engineering services.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:09:50).
- **00:09:56 Office of Building Commissioner: Revised Demolition Contract**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Courtney Walker, Building Commissioner's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Walker presented a contract revision for 1305 East Memorial. Originally awarded for both a house and a garage, the tax sale buyer successfully intervened to save the house. Consequently, only the garage was demolished, reducing the contract fee to \$3,700.00.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:10:45).
- **00:10:49 Office of Community Development Contracts: Homeowner Rehabilitation Program**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nikita Adams, Office of Community Development.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adams presented two contracts for the homeowner rehabilitation program: one for a roofing consultant who meets with applicants and solicits quotes, and a second for Home Savers to handle HVAC systems, water heaters, and accessibility projects.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:11:49).
- **00:11:53 City of Muncie Police Department Employment Agreement: Tactical Paramedic (Ryan Ballard)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Police Chief Sloan.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Chief Sloan presented an employment/service agreement for Ryan Ballard to serve as a tactical paramedic for the SWAT team. The position ensures immediate medical care during critical incidents. Compensation is set at \$52 per hour.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Rick Yenser asked about the financial impact, to which Chief Sloan estimated aggregate costs at around \$3,000 to \$4,000 annually based on average callouts.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:18:19).
- **00:19:01 Bid Opening / Statement of Qualifications: Parks Master Plan**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Adam (Parks Department representative).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board opened statements of qualifications (not financial bids) for professional services to draft the mandated 5-year Parks Master Plan required for DNR grant eligibility. Qualifications/packets were publicly received and recorded from:
 1. American Structure Point (multiple copies)
 2. Flatland Resources
 3. Framework Planning and Design (FRM WRK)
 4. Rundell Ernstberger Associates (REA)
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Received and formally entered into the record to be forwarded to the Park Board for review.
- **00:14:19 Office of Community Development: Habitat for Humanity Change Order**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Gretchen Cheeseman, Director of Community Development.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Cheeseman presented a change order to an agreement with Habitat for Humanity for a new build at 3407 West Charles Street. The adjustment (\$27,662.00 increase) covers compliance with new HUD/IECC (International Energy Conservation Code) 2021 requirements regarding insulation and furnace specifications, bringing the revised contract total to \$112,662.00. Funds are designated and available.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:26:14).
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:26:29 Rick Yenser (Newsman / Author):**
 - Addressed downtown traffic safety concerns near Central, mentioning a recent student/government class proposal regarding traffic control, stoplights near Myrtle, and sidewalks. Requested that the city's engineering contractors examine pedestrian safety protections around the area.
 - Expressed economic development concerns regarding downtown retail/restaurant vacancies following recent closures (naming Berame's, Cassadel Soul, and a Chicago pizza establishment), urging closer oversight of downtown retail health.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Mayor Ridenour highlighted the upcoming joint "State of the Community" event with Delaware County scheduled for the following day, noting strong attendance projections (around 600 attendees).
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned following the conclusion of public comments (00:28:29).
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